

THE LONG LIGHT

Summer is about the space.

The almanac's name for high summer is *taisho*, the greater heat, and the *kō* inside it are some of the loveliest in the year: "warm winds blow," "lotus blossoms open," "earth is damp, air is humid." It is the only season the calendar describes through the air itself — the medium between things rather than the things.

That is summer's lesson for the home. The other seasons ask what to put in a room. Summer asks what to leave out of it, because heat and long light make a full room feel fuller, hotter, more. The cool room in July is not the one with more cooling objects. It is the one with more *air* — cleared surfaces, an open door, a single pale cloth where winter had three.

The Japanese have a word for exactly this: *ma* — 間 — the interval, the space between, the pause that makes the rest legible. And the Norwegians have the impulse the season turns on: *friluftsliv*, open-air living, the instinct to dissolve the line between inside and out. This issue is about both — the empty space, and the open door.

Open one door and leave it open. The room you want is the one with the garden in it.

